

Solara Renewables

Employee Handbook

Version 4.2 | Effective 1 April 2026 | Owner: People & Culture

This handbook applies to all employees of Solara Renewables & Manufacturing Private Limited across all locations.

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1. Welcome to Solara Renewables

On behalf of the leadership team, welcome to Solara Renewables. Since our founding in March 2014, we have grown from a small design team in Pune into a company of 287+ people designing and manufacturing solar string inverters and mounting structures for commercial and industrial customers across India.

This handbook is a practical guide to how we work together — our policies, your entitlements, and the standards we hold ourselves to. It is not a contract of employment; your Employment Contract and applicable law take precedence in the event of any conflict. Policies in this handbook may be updated from time to time, and the current version is always available on the Company intranet (SolaraConnect).

1.1 Our Business

Solara Renewables designs, manufactures and provides EPC support for solar string inverters and rooftop/ground-mount structures, serving commercial and industrial (C&I) solar developers and EPC contractors. We operate two manufacturing plants in the Pune district (Chakan and Ranjangaon), a corporate office in Viman Nagar, Pune, and a sales office in Bengaluru.

1.2 Our Values

- Engineering Integrity — we design and build to last; we do not cut corners on safety or quality.
- Ownership — we take responsibility for outcomes, not just tasks.
- Respect — we treat colleagues, customers, and partners with courtesy and fairness.
- Speed with Discipline — we move quickly, but within process and safety guardrails.

2. Employment Basics

2.1 Employment Types

The Company engages employees under the following categories, each governed by the terms of the individual's Employment Contract:

- Full-time, Permanent — the standard employment category for most roles.
- Full-time, Probationary — new joiners, for the duration of their probation period (typically 3-6 months depending on grade).
- Fixed-Term Contract — for defined project-based or seasonal requirements.

2.2 Working Hours

Standard working hours for corporate office roles are 9:00 AM to 6:00 PM, Monday to Friday, with a 1-hour lunch break. Plant-based roles follow shift schedules (General Shift, Shift A 6:00 AM-2:00 PM, Shift B 2:00 PM-10:00 PM) as notified by the Plant HR team. Employees are expected to record attendance via the biometric system at the plants or the HRIS check-in for corporate/sales office roles.

2.3 Probation and Confirmation

New joiners are typically on probation for 3-6 months depending on grade, as specified in their Employment Contract. Confirmation is based on a formal review between the employee and their Reporting Manager, coordinated by HR, and is not automatic on completion of the probation period.

2.4 Attendance and Punctuality

Employees are expected to be punctual and to record attendance accurately. Persistent unexplained absence or late attendance may be addressed through the counselling and disciplinary process described in Section 13.

2.5 Identity Cards and Access

All employees are issued a photo identity card and, where applicable, an access card for plant or office entry. These must be worn visibly at all times on Company premises and returned to Admin/HR on separation.

3. Code of Conduct & Ethics

Every employee is expected to act with honesty, fairness, and professionalism in all dealings with colleagues, customers, suppliers, and the public.

3.1 General Conduct

- Treat all colleagues, customers, and visitors with courtesy and respect, regardless of role, background, or seniority.
- Avoid conduct that creates a hostile, offensive, or unsafe work environment.
- Maintain confidentiality of Company, customer, and colleague information.
- Use Company assets (equipment, vehicles, IT systems) responsibly and for legitimate business purposes.

3.2 Conflict of Interest

Employees must disclose to HR and their Reporting Manager any situation that could reasonably create a conflict of interest — for example, a financial interest in a supplier or customer, or a close personal relationship with someone in their reporting line. Undisclosed conflicts of interest may be treated as a disciplinary matter.

3.3 Anti-Bribery & Anti-Corruption

Employees must not offer, give, solicit, or accept any bribe, kickback, or improper payment in connection with Company business. Gifts and hospitality from suppliers or customers beyond nominal, customary value must be declined or reported to HR/Compliance.

3.4 Gifts, Entertainment, and Vendor Relations

Modest, occasional gifts of nominal value (below ₹2,500) customary to business relationships may be accepted; anything beyond this threshold must be declined, returned, or, where declining would cause offence, surrendered to HR and logged in the Gift Register.

3.5 Use of Social Media

Employees are free to participate in social media in a personal capacity but must not disclose confidential Company information, speak on the Company's behalf without authorisation, or post content that could bring the Company into disrepute.

4. Anti-Harassment & Prevention of Sexual Harassment (POSH) Policy

Solara Renewables is committed to providing a safe workplace, free from sexual harassment, in compliance with the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013 ("POSH Act").

4.1 What Constitutes Sexual Harassment

Sexual harassment includes unwelcome sexually determined behaviour, whether directly or by implication, including: physical contact and advances; demand or request for sexual favours; sexually coloured remarks; showing pornography; or any other unwelcome physical, verbal, or non-verbal conduct of a sexual nature.

4.2 Internal Committee (IC)

The Company has constituted an Internal Committee under the POSH Act to receive and inquire into complaints. The current IC composition, presiding officer, and contact details are published on SolaraConnect and displayed at all office and plant locations. See the separate 'POSH Compliance Committee — Constitution & Annual Report' document for full details, including the external member and reporting statistics.

4.3 How to Report

A complaint may be made in writing to the Internal Committee within 3 months of the incident (extendable at the Committee's discretion). Complaints may be submitted via email to icc@solararenewables.in, in a sealed letter to the IC Presiding Officer, or verbally to any IC member, who will assist in recording it in writing.

4.4 Confidentiality and Non-Retaliation

The identity of the complainant, respondent, and witnesses will be kept confidential throughout the process, to the extent permitted by law. Retaliation against a complainant or witness is strictly prohibited and will itself be treated as a serious disciplinary matter.

4.5 Process and Timelines

The IC will complete its inquiry within 90 days of receiving a complaint and submit its report and recommendations to the Company, which must act on the recommendations within 60 days, per the POSH Act.

5. Compensation & Benefits

5.1 Salary Structure and Payment

Salaries are paid monthly, credited to the employee's registered bank account by the 1st working day of the following month. Payslips are available through the HRIS employee self-service portal.

5.2 Statutory Benefits

- Provident Fund (PF): 12% of Basic Salary contributed by both employee and employer, per the EPF Act, 1952 (subject to the statutory wage ceiling).
- Gratuity: payable per the Payment of Gratuity Act, 1972, to employees who complete 5 years of continuous service.
- Employees' State Insurance (ESIC): applicable to employees with gross monthly wages up to the statutory threshold, currently ₹21,000.
- Professional Tax: deducted per the applicable state slab (Maharashtra).

5.3 Group Insurance Benefits

- Group Mediclaim Insurance: covering the employee, spouse, and up to 2 dependent children, with a base sum insured of ₹3,00,000 (enhanceable via voluntary top-up at employee cost).
- Group Personal Accident Insurance: sum insured of 3x annual CTC (subject to policy caps).
- Group Term Life Insurance: sum insured of 2x annual CTC.

5.4 Other Benefits

- Meal card / subsidised canteen at plant locations.
- Transport facility (bus/shuttle) between designated pickup points and Plant 1/Plant 2.
- Mobile and internet reimbursement for eligible grades (M1 and above), per the Travel & Expense Policy.
- Annual health check-up for employees at grade M1 and above, and for all plant-based employees per statutory requirements.

6. Leave Policy

The Company's leave year runs from 1 April to 31 March. Leave balances do not carry forward beyond the limits specified below, except where required by state Shops & Establishments regulations.

Leave Type	Entitlement	Key Conditions
Privilege Leave (PL)	15 days/year, accrued at 1.25 days/month	Max carry-forward: 45 days accumulated. Encashable on separation.
Sick Leave (SL)	8 days/year	Medical certificate required beyond 2 consecutive days. Non-encashable.
Casual Leave (CL)	6 days/year	Max 3 consecutive days without manager approval as PL. Non-encashable.
Maternity Leave	26 weeks (first 2 children); 12 weeks thereafter	Per the Maternity Benefit Act, 1961, as amended. Applies to all female employees, no minimum service requirement waiver beyond statutory 80-day threshold.
Paternity Leave	10 working days	Company policy (non-statutory), to be availed within 3 months of childbirth.
Bereavement Leave	5 working days	For death of immediate family member (spouse, child, parent, sibling).
Compensatory Off	Earned on prior approval for work on a weekly-off/holiday	Must be availed within 60 days of accrual.

6.1 Applying for Leave

Leave must be applied for in advance through the HRIS Leave Management Module, except in cases of medical emergency, where the employee (or a family member) should inform the Reporting Manager as soon as reasonably possible and regularise the application on return.

6.2 Public Holidays

The Company observes 10-12 public holidays each calendar year, notified in December for the following year, including national holidays (Republic Day, Independence Day, Gandhi Jayanti) and regionally observed festivals.

7. Health, Safety & Environment (EHS)

Safety is a shared responsibility. All employees, particularly those working at Plant 1 and Plant 2, must comply with EHS protocols at all times.

7.1 General Safety Requirements

- Wear the prescribed Personal Protective Equipment (PPE) in designated areas at all times (safety shoes, safety glasses, ESD wrist straps in electronics assembly areas).
- Follow Lockout/Tagout (LOTO) procedures before servicing or clearing jams on any powered equipment.
- Report any unsafe condition, near-miss, or incident to your supervisor and the EHS team immediately, using the Incident Report Form on SolaraConnect.
- Participate in mandatory fire safety and evacuation drills, conducted at least twice a year at each plant.

7.2 Incident Reporting and Investigation

All incidents, including near-misses, must be reported within 24 hours. The EHS team will investigate incidents resulting in injury or significant property damage and issue a Corrective and Preventive Action (CAPA) report within 7 working days.

7.3 Environmental Compliance

The Company is committed to responsible handling and disposal of electronic waste, packaging materials, and hazardous substances (e.g., solder, cleaning agents) per applicable Pollution Control Board norms. Employees handling such materials must follow the plant's Waste Management SOP.

8. Information Technology & Information Security Policy

8.1 Acceptable Use

Company IT assets (laptops, email, network access) are provided for business use. Limited, reasonable personal use is permitted provided it does not interfere with work, consume excessive resources, or violate this policy.

8.2 Password and Access Management

- Use strong, unique passwords for Company systems and enable multi-factor authentication where offered.
- Never share login credentials with anyone, including colleagues or IT support staff.
- Lock your workstation when unattended.

8.3 Data Protection and Confidentiality

Employees must not store Company confidential data (customer data, design files, financial data) on personal devices or unauthorised cloud storage. All confidential data must be handled per its classification (Public, Internal, Confidential, Restricted) as defined in the Information Classification Standard.

8.4 Incident Reporting

Suspected phishing emails, lost/stolen devices, or any suspected security incident must be reported immediately to IT Security at itsecurity@solararenewables.in.

8.5 Software and Licensing

Only Company-approved and licensed software may be installed on Company devices. Installation of unauthorised or pirated software is a disciplinary matter.

9. Learning & Development

The Company invests in employee growth through structured training, certifications, and on-the-job development.

9.1 Mandatory Training

All employees must complete the following within the timelines specified: POSH Awareness Training (within 30 days of joining, annually thereafter), Information Security Awareness (within 30 days of joining, annually thereafter), and role-specific safety training for plant-based roles (before working unsupervised on the shop floor).

9.2 Skill Development Support

Employees may request sponsorship for relevant external certifications and training programs through their Reporting Manager, subject to budget approval and a minimum post-training service commitment for programs above ₹50,000 in cost.

9.3 Internal Mobility

Employees who have completed 18 months in their current role and are in good standing may apply for internally posted openings through the Internal Job Posting (IJP) process on SolaraConnect.

10. Performance Management

The Company follows an annual performance management cycle aligned to the fiscal year (April-March), comprising goal-setting, a mid-year check-in, and a year-end review.

10.1 Goal Setting

Goals are set within the first 6 weeks of the fiscal year, aligned to team and company objectives, and documented in the Performance Management module of the HRIS.

10.2 Mid-Year and Year-End Reviews

Managers and employees conduct a documented mid-year check-in (typically October) and a formal year-end review (typically March-April), covering goal achievement, competencies, and development areas. See the separate Performance Review template for the full form.

10.3 Rating Scale

Rating	Description
5 - Outstanding	Consistently and significantly exceeds expectations across goals and competencies.
4 - Exceeds Expectations	Regularly exceeds expectations on most goals.
3 - Meets Expectations	Fully meets the expectations of the role.
2 - Needs Improvement	Partially meets expectations; a development or improvement plan is required.
1 - Unsatisfactory	Consistently below expectations; formal Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) required.

10.4 Performance Improvement Plans (PIP)

Employees rated 'Needs Improvement' or 'Unsatisfactory', or facing sustained performance concerns identified outside the formal cycle, may be placed on a Performance Improvement Plan of 30-90 days, with clearly defined, measurable goals and regular check-ins with their manager and HR.

11. Travel & Expense Policy

11.1 Domestic Travel

Grade	Air Travel	Hotel (per night, cap)	Local Conveyance
E1-E4	Economy, booked via approved travel desk	₹4,500	Actuals with receipts / app-based cab
M1-M2	Economy, flexible fare permitted for same-day return	₹6,500	Actuals with receipts
L1 and above	Business class for flights over 4 hours	₹9,500	Actuals

11.2 Expense Claims

Expense claims must be submitted through the HRIS Expense Module within 15 days of travel, with original receipts (or digital copies) attached. Claims submitted after 60 days require Finance Head approval and may be declined thereafter.

11.3 Mobile and Internet Reimbursement

Employees at grade M1 and above, and field-based Sales employees at any grade, are eligible for mobile/internet reimbursement up to ₹1,500/month against actuals.

12. Grievance Redressal

Employees who have a work-related grievance (other than sexual harassment complaints, which follow the POSH process in Section 4) are encouraged to raise it promptly through the following escalation path:

1. Discuss informally with your immediate Reporting Manager.
2. If unresolved within 7 working days, escalate in writing to your Department Head, copying HR.
3. If still unresolved, escalate to the Senior Manager - HR (Employee Relations & Compliance), who will investigate and respond within 15 working days.
4. Grievances relating to compensation, promotion, or performance ratings may additionally be raised through the annual Calibration Appeal window, communicated by HR at the close of each review cycle.

All grievances will be handled confidentially, and employees will not face retaliation for raising a grievance in good faith.

13. Disciplinary Policy

The Company follows a principle of progressive discipline for performance and conduct issues, except in cases of gross misconduct, which may warrant immediate action.

13.1 Examples of Misconduct

- Minor: repeated unpunctuality, unauthorised absence, non-compliance with dress code or minor SOP deviations.
- Major: insubordination, harassment, breach of confidentiality, conflict of interest non-disclosure, repeated policy violations after warning.
- Gross: theft, fraud, violence, being under the influence of alcohol/drugs at work, serious safety violations, sexual harassment (handled under the POSH Policy).

13.2 Process

5. Verbal counselling and documentation for minor first instances.
6. Written warning for repeated or moderate issues, with a copy filed in the employee's HR record.
7. Show-cause notice and inquiry for major/gross misconduct, with the employee given an opportunity to respond, and may include suspension pending inquiry (with subsistence allowance per the Industrial Employment (Standing Orders) Act, where applicable).
8. Final action — ranging from final written warning, to termination — based on the inquiry findings, approved by HR and the relevant Department Head.

See the Disciplinary Action Record template for the documentation format used at each stage.

14. Separation & Exit Policy

14.1 Resignation

Employees wishing to resign should submit a written resignation to their Reporting Manager and HR, and serve the notice period specified in their Employment Contract (typically 30-60 days depending on grade), unless a shorter period is mutually agreed or bought out.

14.2 Exit Process

9. Resignation acceptance and Last Working Day (LWD) confirmation by HR.
10. Knowledge transfer and handover plan agreed with the Reporting Manager.
11. Clearance from IT (asset return), Admin (ID/access card), Finance (dues/advances), and the relevant department.
12. Exit interview conducted by HR (see Exit Interview & Offboarding Checklist template).
13. Full and Final (F&F) settlement processed within 45 days of the Last Working Day, including any leave encashment, gratuity (if eligible), and recovery of dues.

14.3 Relieving and Experience Letters

A Relieving Letter and Experience Letter will be issued on completion of clearance and the notice period, provided all Company property has been returned and dues settled.

15. Acknowledgement

I acknowledge that I have received, read, and understood the Solara Renewables Employee Handbook (Version 4.2, effective 1 April 2026). I understand that this handbook does not constitute an employment contract and that policies may be amended from time to time, with changes communicated via SolaraConnect.

Employee Name: _____ Employee ID: _____

Signature: _____ Date: _____